

— BUILD IN PUBLIC · AI ENABLEMENT

I'm building a game to learn how to actually **work alongside AI.**

Not a tech demo. A real project — **Hollowfen** — where I find out what the model can do, what it can't, and exactly where the line between us sits.



A field notebook from the build.

— THE PROJECT

Hollowfen — The Failing Village.

A third-person foraging game. You play **Wren**, a young mushroom-identifier who returns to a damp, half-abandoned medieval village and slowly rebuilds it by learning to *read the forest* — which mushrooms feed people, and which kill them.

THE STACK

Unity · URP scene & assets

Claude ↔ Unity **MCP server**

Meshy · character generation

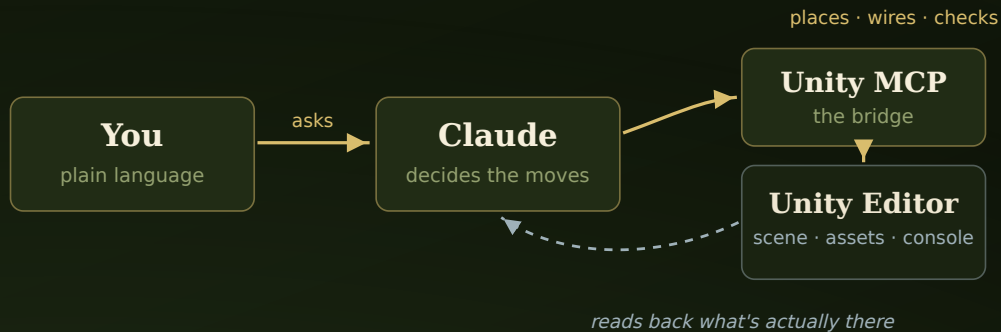
Blender · asset prep & export

Purchased **Medieval Village** asset pack

Three.js · playable web prototype

— THE MECHANIC THAT MAKES IT WORK

Claude reads & writes the Unity editor directly.



I describe what I want in words. Claude **inspects the open scene** over the MCP server, places assets, wires up components, and reads the console back — then tells me what changed.

I stay the director. It does the editor work.

[SCREENSHOT: UNITY EDITOR + CLAUDE SESSION SIDE-BY-SIDE, MCP SERVER CONNECTED]

Fill in the exact MCP server name — [MCP SERVER NAME] — in the caption.

A village you can actually walk.

Built from a purchased *Medieval Fantasy Town Village* pack — individual building and prop prefabs dropped into a hand-authored layout, with collision walls and punched-out doorways so Wren moves through it, not into it.

The **damp, failing mood** comes from low fog and a driven sky — overcast by day, warm lanterns creeping in at dusk.

I said: “Give me a damp, lived-in medieval village — not a fantasy theme park.”



[SCREENSHOT]

Hollowfen village in third-person — Wren on a foggy lane between timber houses.



[SCREENSHOT]

Wren close-up + the animation states: idle · walk ·
run · jump.

Wren, the forager.

The character was generated in **Meshy**, then brought in with a full animation set — idle, walk, run, jump — driven by a third-person controller: WASD to move, shift to run, space to jump, drag to turn the camera.

Height-normalized and re-lit so she sits inside the world instead of on top of it.

I said: *“A young woman with a forager's satchel and practical clothes — she studies mushrooms, she doesn't fight.”*

The forage-and-identify loop.

16 mushroom species, each with real field-guide data — Latin name, edibility, ID features, habitat, season, and the toxic look-alikes that make it dangerous.

You find one, read the cues, and decide. Get it right, it enters your guide. Misread a **Death Cap** for a Field Mushroom — and that's the whole tension.

Chanterelle

Cantharellus cibarius

EDIBLE · CHOICE

THE TELL

False gills — **forked ridges** running down the stem, not blade-like gills.

DEADLY LOOK-ALIKE

Jack-O'-Lantern — **toxic**, has true gills, clumps on wood.

1 of 16 in Wren's field guide

[SCREENSHOT: THE IN-GAME FIELD GUIDE ENTRY / IDENTIFICATION PROMPT]

What I said vs. what appeared.

I SAID

“The village should feel damp and half-abandoned — overcast light, fog sitting low, and warmer lanterns as it gets toward dusk.”



WHAT APPEARED

A driven sky + fog system with a **time-of-day control** — dawn → noon → dusk → night. Sun intensity, sky haze, fog colour and exposure all shift with the hour; the fog warms at dusk and goes blue-black by night.

dawn

noon

dusk

night

The gap between those two boxes is the whole skill: say it precisely enough, and the scene is what comes back.

— WHAT THIS TAUGHT ME

The win isn't the tool. It's knowing where the **line** sits.

01

Fast & literal in the editor. A clear, bounded ask gets placed, wired and checked faster than I could by hand.

02

Not a designer. “Make it good” gives mush. “Fog low, light warm at dusk” gives the scene.

03

My job moved from doing the clicks to holding the vision, breaking it down, and judging the result.

AI enablement, for me, is two kinds of **specific**: specific about intent — and specific about where the model stops and I start.

— STILL IN PROGRESS

Hollowfen is still being **built**.

This was the **workflow** — the loop, the mechanics, where AI carried the weight and where I had to. The full illustrated story of Wren and the failing village is a separate piece.

Following along in public →

The story cards + deeper write-up are linked separately.

Let's connect if you're figuring out where AI fits in your own work.